

Notorious wrecks

1 RMS Titanic
On April 14, 1912, this ship struck an iceberg and sank two hours and forty minutes later.
Death toll: 1,517

2 USS Arizona
Sunk in the opening minutes of the Japanese attack on the US Navy at Pearl Harbor in 1942.
Death toll: 1,177

3 RMS Lusitania
British liner sunk by a

World War I German submarine in 1915.
Death toll: 1,200

4 Bismarck
German battleship, lost after battling the British Royal Navy in May 1941.
Death toll: 2,085

5 Nuestra Señora de Atocha
Spanish galleon, laden with treasure, caught in a hurricane in 1622.
Death toll: 260

6 Wilhelm Gustloff
German passenger ship torpedoed by a Russian submarine in 1945.
Death toll: approx. 9,100

7 HMS Sussex
Royal Navy ship lost in a storm off Gibraltar in 1694, carrying over 11 tons of gold coins.
Death toll: 500

8 MV Doña Paz
Passenger ferry that collided with an oil

tanker off the Philippines in 1987.
Death toll: 4,375

9 HMS Birkenhead
British ship that sank after striking rocks at Danger Point in 1852.
Death toll: 460

10 Batavia
Dutch ship that sank off Australia in 1629, on its maiden voyage.
Death toll: wreck 40; later mutiny 233

Battle of Midway (1942)

US ships *Yorktown* and *Hammann* were lost here, along with four Japanese aircraft carriers and a cruiser, in one of World War II's fiercest naval battles.

Eduard Bohlen (1909)

Ran aground in fog and now lies 1,300 ft (400 m) inland, half-buried in huge sand dunes.

HMS Pandora (1791)

Sank while on a mission to find the HMS *Bounty* and her mutinous crew.

Man-made shipwrecks

Humans can be responsible for shipwrecks in many different ways. War is one of the main causes—missiles, mines, air attacks, and sabotage have all been used to destroy ships. Other factors can be bad design, shoddy construction, or poor maintenance and repairs; navigation errors that cause a ship to run aground or hit other traffic; and overloading cargo so that the vessel tips over.

